

ARLINGTON COUNTY, VIRGINIA

**County Board Agenda Item
Meeting of June 10, 2023**

DATE: June 7, 2023

SUBJECT: Proposed new maximum annual salary cap for County Board Members and the Board Chair effective January 1, 2024.

C. M. RECOMMENDATION:

Approve a new maximum annual salary cap of \$119, 833.00 per year for County Board Members and \$125, 460.00 per year for the Board Chair effective January 1, 2024

ISSUES: This is a request to consider should the County Board Members increase the four-year salary cap for County Board Members and the County Board Chair.

SUMMARY: This information is provided so the Board may consider its maximum pay over the next four years. It is recommended that the Board apply the same methodology used the [last time the salary cap was considered](#) (CY 2019). If adopted, the salary cap would increase to \$119,833 for members and \$125,460 for the Board chair. These caps would be in effect at least through December 31, 2027.

BACKGROUND: The Board may set its maximum salary only once every four years and must be established prior to July 1 of the year in which at least 40% (two) of the County Board seats are up for election. The new maximum is effective on January 1 of the calendar year following that action. In Calendar Year 2019, the County Board last acted to establish a maximum salary for the Chair and Board Members using a methodology based on 100 percent of the AMI for an Individual for Calendar Year 2019 as the base and escalating at an annual rate of 2.27 percent through Calendar Year 2023.

DISCUSSION: The current salary cap for Arlington County Board Members is \$89,851 with the Chair's salary capped at \$95,734. The current salary set for Members is \$77,648 and \$83,413 for the Chair. These salaries are expected to increase to the current maximums in FY 2024.

Jurisdictions in the region were surveyed this spring to see how Arlington County Board Member salaries compared to others in the area. Pay rates for members ranged from \$37,500 to

County Manager:

MJS / MJC

County Attorney:

MNC

Staff: Tamara Galliani, Classification and Compensation Division Chief

\$123,283 and ranged from \$41,500 to \$138,283 for chairpersons. The table below details the survey.

FY 2024						
Jurisdiction	Chairman			Board Member		
	Jur Title	Actual Annual	Annual Maximum	Jur Title	Actual Annual	Annual Maximum
Alexandria	Mayor	\$41,500	NA	Vice Mayor City Council	\$37,500	NA
Fairfax	Chairman	\$138,283	NA	Board Member	\$123,283	NA
Loudoun	Chairman	\$91,064	\$99,508	District Supervisor	\$75,916	\$82,956
Prince William	Chairman	\$84,086	NA	District Supervisor	\$74,000	NA
Average FFX & PW	Chairman	\$111,185	NA	Average FFX & PW	\$98,642	NA
Average All	Chairman	\$88,733	NA	Average All	\$77,675	NA
Arlington	Chairman	\$95,734	\$95,734	Board Member	\$89,851	\$89,851

Applying the salary calculation method consistent with the Board's last change in 2019, the Member salary cap would increase to \$119,833 and to \$125,460 for the Chair. This calculation is based on the 2023 average median income (AMI) at 100% for an individual (\$106,470) escalated at 3% annually through calendar year 2027. For the County Board Chair, an additional \$5,000 is added to the base to recognize the additional duties in the role of the chair. The escalation rate is the five-year average of merit-base salary increases for General employees.

The County Board has had the authority under state law to establish its own level of pay since January 2007. If the Board approves a new cap in 2023, it would be effective January 1, 2024. The portion of the maximum salary that the County Board funds and actually pays is subject to annual appropriation.

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT: Discussion of County Board Member salaries and salary cap were discussed as a part of the FY 2024 budget adoption process. In addition, a public hearing on FY 2024 budget was held on March 28, 2023.

FISCAL IMPACT: Because the Board is only resetting the salary cap at this time, there is no immediate fiscal impact.